

The edifice is built to defy the powers of the air and fire — massively, of stone, iron, brick and glass, with thin veneerings of wooden floorings; its ruins ages hence may for aught we know be among those which the coming New Zealander may gaze upon as he sits on a mound of dust which was once old Trinity and moralizes on the fall of nations.

*The environs of the Stock Exchange . . .
throws a light, more or less lurid, over the
whole financial community.*

A dull sound like the murmur of distant waters greets the ear as we stand before it. Let us enter between the corinthian columns through the Broad street door. A deep hall with lofty ceiling supported by fluted iron pillars, covers the length and breadth of the ground floor in the form of a letter L. Through the apertures in the thick walls in front and rear and through opaque plates of glass from above, streams in a dim, though not a religious light, by which we can hardly recognize the faces in a roaring screaming, turbulent crowd. This is the "Long Room," so-called. To the left, as we enter, is a broad stair-case with solid-set balusters leading to the upper room, where the members of this Stock Exchange hold their regular sessions. Directly in front of us is a heavy railing pierced with a gateway, where sits the Cerberus of this Hades, whose office it is to see that none pass inside of this barrier except the members of the Board of Brokers and outsiders who have paid one hundred dollars for a year's privilege of being spectators of the purchases and sales, and of giving their orders to buy or sell on the spot to the Brokers whom they employ. Passing inside this railing we find ourselves on a marble-paved floor fifty by fifty, beyond which rises an elevated platform, seventy by fifty, abutting on the west, on the New Street side. The centre of this platform is scooped into an elliptical pit graded by a series of steps encircled by an iron railing, and capable of con-